

Circle Online Community Setup Guide

This document outlines the step-by-step process for setting up a community on Circle, based on the provided tutorial information.

1. Initial Setup

Action	Details
Create an Account	Go to Circle.so and click "Get Started."
Community Name & Privacy	Choose a name for your community. Decide if it is Public or Private . Setting it to Private ensures only invited members can access it (can be changed later).
Setup Guide	Utilize the "Getting Started" guide provided by Circle to walk through necessary steps before going live.

2. Profile & Branding

Action	Details
Complete Profile	Add a photo, full name, headline, and bio. Set visibility preferences for your email and ensure you are in the member directory.
Customization	Upload your logo, community icon, and choose your brand color to match your business styling.

3. Organizing Spaces

Creating Groups and Spaces

Element	Action/Tip	Access/Type Options
Space Groups	Create logical groups (e.g., "Welcome") to organize the community.	Tip: You can hide member counts and hide groups from non-members for exclusivity.
Spaces	Add individual spaces within the groups (e.g., "Start Here", "Introduce Yourself").	Space Types: Feed, List, or Cards.

Space Access Settings

Access Setting	Description
Open	Accessible by all members.
Private	Accessible only by invited members.
Secret	Hidden from non-members.

4. Creating Content & Posts

Action	Details
Welcome Post	Create a post in your "Start Here" space with a video walkthrough and community guidelines.
Formatting	Use the forward slash (/) for formatting options like bulleted lists, images, videos, and files.
Post Settings	For instructional posts, pin them to the top and hide meta info (likes/comments) to make them

Action	Details
	look more like a page than a feed post.

5. Managing Members

Action	Details
Invitation Links	Create customized invitation links in the Member settings. These can be set to automatically add new users to specific space groups.
Integration	If using a third party (e.g., Squarespace) for payments, send these invitation links via email after a purchase is completed.

6. Final Settings

Action	Details
Home Page	Enable the Home tab to create a personalized feed of posts for members.
Mobile App	Enable the app download banner so members can easily access the community on their phones.
Safety	Enforce email verification for new signups to ensure security.